Presented by Argentina Aobscura

DEVELOPMENT PLAN

REDITUS UMBRAE PROJECT

https://apokriptos.github.io/aobscuragames/

DEVELOPMENT CONTEXT & CONSTRAINTS

01

Reditus Umbrae is developed by a five-person collaborative team led by Santiago Pérez Losanovscky as Lead Developer. The playable prototype already includes core combat, room and wave systems, five enemy archetypes, XP/level-ups, zone progression and the upgrade framework.

02

The team is collaborative rather than a formalized production studio. **Aobscura Games is presenting** the project; external financing would allow the collaboration to move toward a dedicated production team.

03

Scope is managed through these milestones: consolidate the prototype, deliver one complete production-ready zone, then expand into full multi-zone production. Funding determines the pace of that transition.

04

The current build proves the gameplay direction but still relies substantially on placeholder character and enemy content. The next production phase requires original player and enemy assets, animation, audio, VFX, UI polish, and a cohesive visual identity.

FUNDING STRATEGY

• Secure a publishing partnership and external financing for production.

• Target up to USD 500K, with final budget and milestone structure defined with the partner according to scope. Lower financing would support a narrower vertical-slice phase rather than full production.

• Prioritize dedicated team time, original player and enemy art and animation, expanded combat and progression content, specialist engineering, audio/VFX/QA, technical optimization, and a polished one-zone vertical slice.

• Keep co-development or investment as viable secondary paths, with grants and crowdfunding as fallback options.

MARKET POSITIONING & PLATFORM STRATEGY

CONSOLES

Reditus Umbrae is planned as a PC-first release, with console versions considered after the core production is established.

TARGET AUDIENCE

The game targets players who enjoy dark-fantasy action roguelites, expressive combat, room-based runs, and build experimentation + emergence.

Its over-the-top aggression is aimed to reward players who enjoy the sensation of havoc, struggle and destruction, allowing them to toss and dismay enemies around the arenas, throw them into pits, against traps, and discovering their own ways to overcome challenging compositions.

PRODUCT POSITION

The game sits between a room-based action roguelite and a physics-forward arena brawler: direct melee and ranged combat is shaped by enemy roles, movement, impact, and run-level build decisions.

Its “always fight” philosophy, challenging enemy compositions, emergent and mechanic-changing upgrades, persistent progression, and damned aesthetic create clear hooks for the lovers of the genre.

PRODUCTION PARTNERSHIP

A publishing partner would enable the transition from collaborative prototype to dedicated production through:

- Finalized scope, budget, and milestones
- Dedicated cadence and production formalization
- Original player, enemy, environment, and animation production
- Expanded combat/progression plus engineering, audio, VFX, QA, and optimization

NEXT PHASE

- Validate the project at EVA B2B
- Deliver a production-ready one-zone vertical slice
- Establish a sustainable team and production budget
- Convert publisher conversations into a financing path

REDITUS UMBRAE ROADMAP

2026-2027: from playable prototype to a vertical slice

PRE-PRODUCTION

- Lock one-zone vertical-slice scope
- Finalize complete run structure & progression
- Define original character, enemy & boss briefs
- Plan production cadence, budget and specialist needs

MILESTONES

- Zone scope and milestone plan locked
- Combat, upgrade & progression targets defined
- Arena, reward and boss structure mapped
- Partner and financing conversations ongoing

OCT — DEC 2026

CORE PRODUCTION

- Produce original player, enemies & boss assets
- Build complete combat-room network and encounters
- Expand upgrades, elemental paths, shop & rewards
- Integrate animation, audio, VFX and UI foundations

MILESTONES

- Main zone playable end-to-end
- Five enemy roles integrated at production quality
- Mini-boss, zone boss and progression spaces functional
- Persistent progression and SaveGame validated

JAN — JUN 2027

SLICE ASSEMBLY & POLISH

- Complete one polished production-ready zone
- Tune combat, physics, waves and build balance
- Run external playtests, profiling and QA passes
- Refine art, animation, VFX, audio and UI quality bar

MILESTONES

- Vertical slice content complete
- Combat and progression blockers resolved
- Original audiovisual presentation integrated
- Publisher-ready slice candidate

JUL — SEP 2027

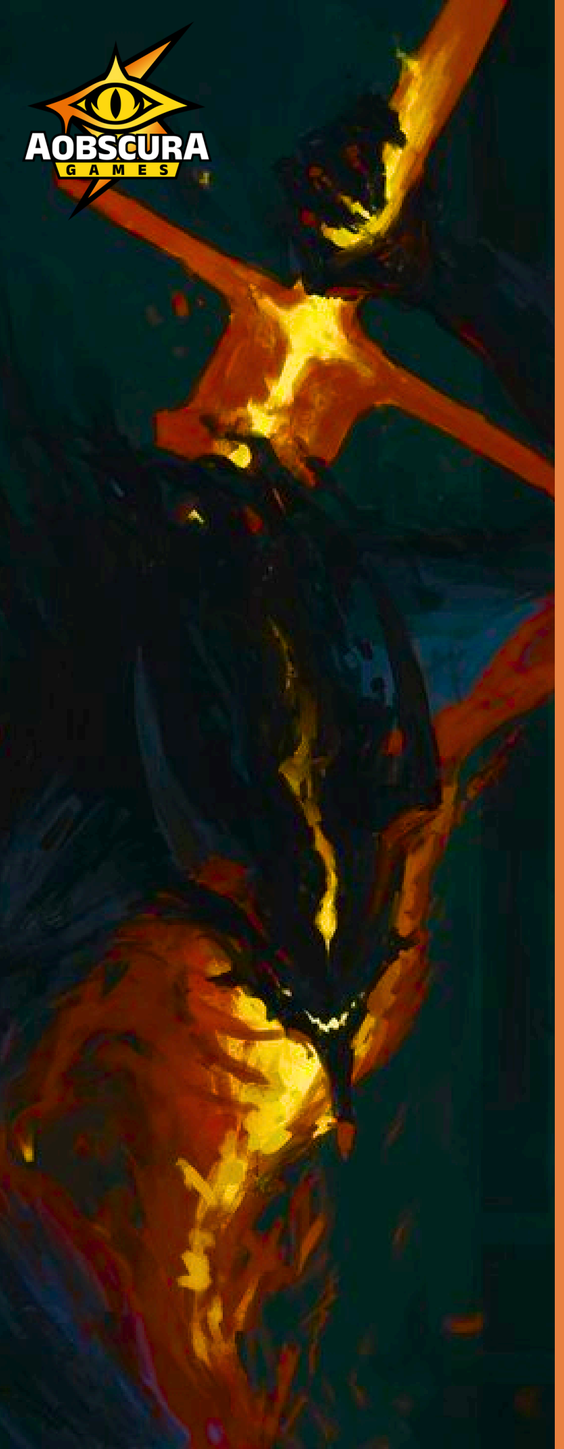
REVIEW & TRANSITION

- Finalize and package the vertical slice
- Present to publishers and strategic partners
- Define full-production budget, team and milestones
- Prepare next-zone production if financing is secured

MILESTONES

- Production-ready vertical slice delivered
- Funding and partnership conversations advanced
- Full-production plan and team structure defined
- 2028 roadmap set from financing outcome

OCT — DEC 2027



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GAME DESIGN

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GAME DESIGN — NEXT MILESTONE OBJECTIVES

A Finalize the complete one-zone loop: combat rooms → waves → rewards and route choices → special rooms and shop → mini-boss → zone boss.

B Expand progression into a layered system of baseline stat growth, special rewards, at least three elemental paths, and meaningful build synergies.

C Tune player combat and the five enemy archetypes around readable roles, impact, movement, knockback, positioning, and clear audiovisual feedback.

D Design and validate the first persistent progression loop, converting resources earned during a zone into meaningful cross-run progression.

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GAME DESIGN

Focus

Reditus Umbrae is driven by continuous combat, enemy-role composition, and run-defining progression. Rooms create immediate arena pressure; upgrades, reward types, and route decisions determine how the player answers that pressure over the course of a zone.

2027 Priorities

The next design phase consolidates the prototype into one complete production-ready run: refining melee, ranged, dash, and heavy combat; the five current enemy archetypes; mini-boss and boss encounters; upgrade selection; special reward rooms; the shop; elemental paths; and persistent progression.

Player Agency

Player agency comes from build direction, combat tactics and reward choice: which upgrades to pursue, when to spend at shops, which special rooms are worth entering, and how elemental, status, and mechanic-changing powers are combined during a run.

Difficulty & Accessibility

Difficulty is built through composition, timing, and room pressure rather than simply inflating enemy health. Enemy budgets, simultaneous-enemy limits, readable roles, and authored wave parameters allow encounters to scale while remaining understandable under stress.

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LEVEL DESIGN

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LEVEL DESIGN

LEVEL DESIGN — NEXT MILESTONE OBJECTIVES

A Design and iterate one complete zone through escalating encounters, reward spaces, the mini-boss, and the final boss arena.

B Standardize arena dimensions, spawn logic, movement space, reward presentation, and room affordances so they remain readable and reusable.

C Author wave datasets that combine the five enemy archetypes through enemy budgets, creating interesting encounters.

D Integrate and polish level-up rewards, special ability rooms, an in-run shop, and other progression spaces.

E Deliver a polished complete-zone slice that proves the room-to-room run structure and serves as the level-design baseline for future zones.

LEVEL DESIGN

Structure

Each zone is organized as a sequence or network of combat arenas, reward spaces, special rooms, and shop opportunities that build toward a final boss. Rooms must support readable movement and distinct enemy compositions.

2027 Scope

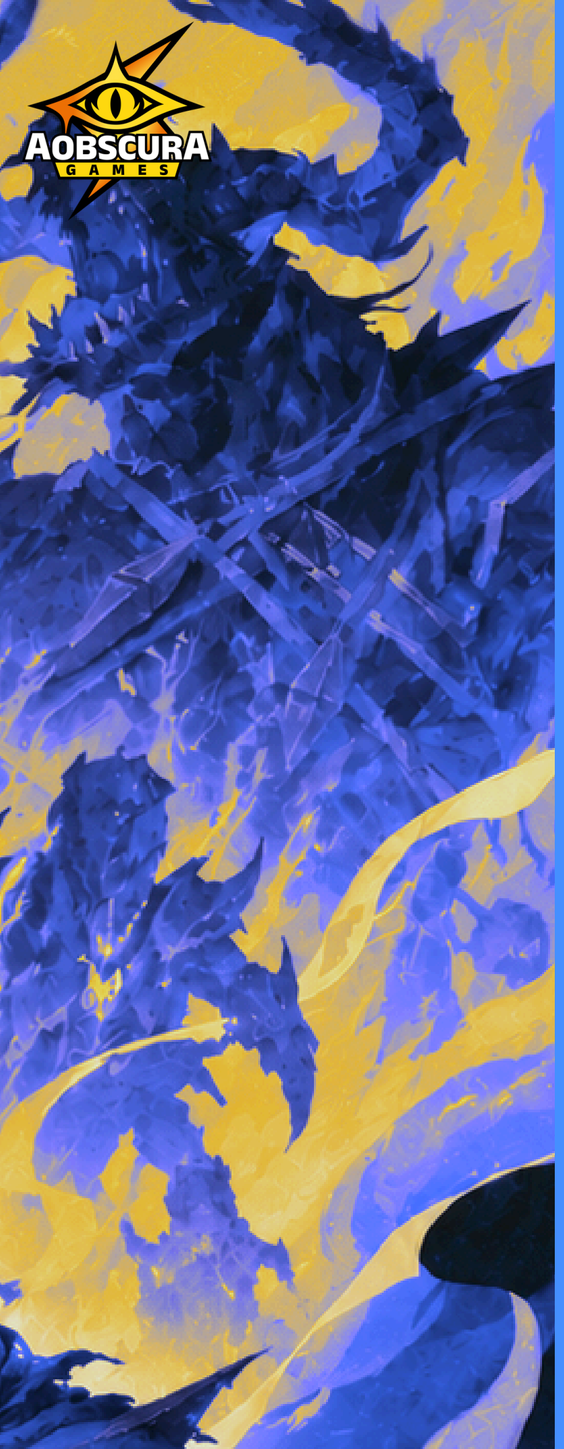
The next level-design milestone is a polished complete zone that represents the intended production quality and validates the run from its opening combat rooms through rewards, route decisions, special spaces, mini-boss, and final boss encounter.

Gameplay Loop

A zone follows the core loop: enter arena → survive waves → gain XP and resources → choose upgrades or rewards → select the next opportunity → visit special rooms → confront the zone boss.

Encounter & Run Pacing

Combat pressure is controlled through authored wave data, enemy budgets, and simultaneous-enemy limits. Between fights, reward categories, shops, and special rooms create breathing space and clear build choices so pacing alternates intensity with deliberate progression.



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DEV

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PROGRAMMING — NEXT MILESTONE OBJECTIVES

A Finalize the DataTable-driven upgrade catalogue, authored ranks and requirements, runtime rank tracking, candidate generation, and application.

B Finish implementing reusable Stats, Upgrade Feature, and Status Effect systems that support upgrades and mechanic-changing elemental powers.

C Extend reward selection contexts so normal level-ups, special rooms, shops, and future evolutions can share scalable eligibility and pipelines.

D Harden room, wave, spawning, and enemy-AI architecture while improving profiling, debugging, playtest visibility, and production tooling.

E Implement persistent progression and save architecture as a separate layer from temporary run data.

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DEV

Focus

Programming supports combat, enemy AI, room and wave flow, XP and level-ups, upgrades, status effects, rewards, and persistent progression. Reditus Umbrae is built in Unreal Engine 5.8 with a Blueprint-first, data-driven approach designed for rapid iteration.

2027 Scope

Harden the prototype through:

- Data-driven upgrade ranks
- Upgrade Manager, Stats & Status systems
- Reward contexts: level-up / room / shop
- Room, wave & enemy-AI architecture
- Persistent progression / SaveGame
- Profiling, debugging & production tools

Technical Philosophy

The technical strategy separates authored data from runtime state and favors modular systems over one-off logic. Gameplay-facing iteration stays accessible in Blueprints and data assets, while performance-critical or lower-level foundations can move into C++ as production needs become clear.

Constraints & Sustainability

The current technical direction is maintained by the project lead within a collaborative team. Production funding would support specialist engineering where needed while keeping core gameplay systems understandable and maintainable by designers and additional developers.

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ANIMATION

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ANIMATION — NEXT MILESTONE OBJECTIVES

A Make the original player rig and core animation set: traversal, three-hit melee combo, charged heavy attack, ranged attack, dash, etc.

B Build movement, attack, reaction, and death animation sets for the five current enemy archetypes.

C Create a complete mini-boss animation set.

D Create the zone boss animation set with signature attacks, readable telegraphs, reactions, state changes, and phase-specific behavior.

E Integrate player and enemy animation with combat state logic, collisions, knockback, physics handoff, VFX, audio, and gameplay feedback.

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ANIMA-TION

Role in the Experience

Animation is central to combat timing, readability, and impact in Reditus Umbrae. Player attacks, movement, reactions, and transitions must feel responsive, while enemy animation communicates archetype, threat, telegraphing, hit response, and state changes under arena pressure.

2027 Scope

Focused vertical-slice animation scope:

- Original player character rig and combat set
- Five enemy archetype animation sets
- One mini-boss animation set
- One dedicated zone-boss animation set
- Readable reactions, deaths, impact, and physics handoff

Style & Direction

The animation direction is aggressive, exaggerated, and weighty while preserving readable telegraphs and responsive transitions. Hits, charges, heavy attacks, dodges, knockback, and deaths should sell physical force without sacrificing combat agility and pacing.

Production Approach

Animation production favors reusable foundations where practical, modular state-driven sets, and tight gameplay integration before final polish. The priority is to replace prototype motion with production-ready animation that remains easy to extend and re-target across future enemies and zones.

NARRATIVE

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NARRATIVE — NEXT MILESTONE OBJECTIVES

A Define the narrative arc and context for one complete zone, from the opening encounter through narrative halls and final boss confrontation.

B Establish the punishment-cycle premise, the player's immediate objective, and the shadow rules of the realm.

C Write zone-specific narrative beats between combat rooms, the shop, the mini-boss, the boss, etc., so progression carries thematic meaning.

D Integrate lore with enemy identities, environmental details, upgrade naming, rewards, and transitions.

E Plant hooks for the wider multi-zone structure and future revelations about the protagonist, the realm, and the Architect of Punishment.

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NARRA-TIVE

Worldbuilding & Lore

Narrative gives the combat loop identity and purpose. The player is trapped in a nightmarish realm of punishment, and each run pushes them deeper into a cycle shaped by violence, guilt, and the forces responsible for their torment, as they confront their past sins and subsequent repentance.

2027 Scope

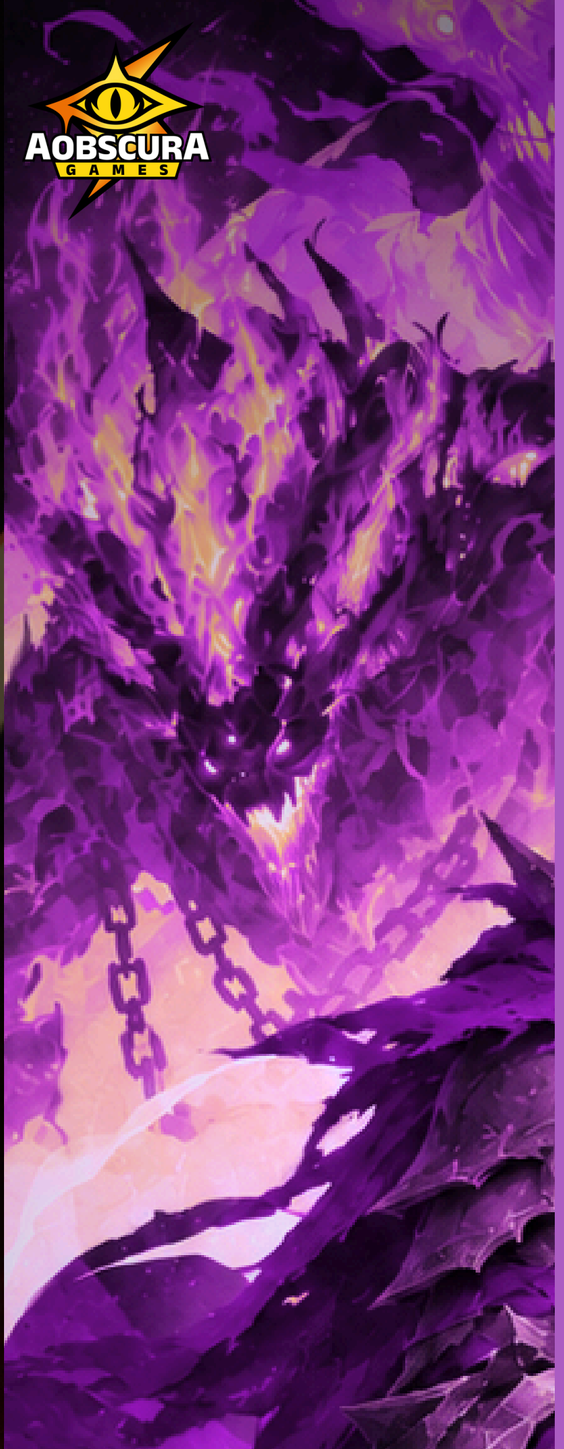
The vertical slice establishes one zone as a complete narrative unit: the logic of the punishment cycle, the identity of the environment and its enemies, the meaning of its reward spaces, and the escalation from ordinary combatants to zone boss.

Narrative Delivery

Storytelling is delivered through environment, room identity, enemy and boss presentation, short contextual text or dialogue, upgrade and reward naming, and transitions between encounters. Narrative beats should inspire momentum or offer a chance at taking the edge off after a peak of struggle.

Narrative Philosophy

Narrative supports the run rather than interrupting it. The game should create questions around the protagonist, the realm, past sins and the War while allowing combat, progression, and repeated attempts to remain the primary rhythm.



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ART

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ART — NEXT MILESTONE OBJECTIVES

A Define the finalized production visual language for the first Reditus Umbrae zone and the modular environment kit required to build its room sequence.

B Design and produce the original player character direction and establish the combat, reward, shop, and progression UI language.

C Finalize the five enemy archetypes, mini-boss, and zone boss as original production-ready characters that can move into rigging and animation.

D Create the environment kit and room identities for combat arenas, special rewards, the in-run shop, mini-boss encounter, and final boss arena.

E Define readable elemental VFX and iconography for Fire, Electricity, Ice powers, and integrate them with upgrade, status, and reward presentation.

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ART

Visual Language

Clarity through contrast:

- Player — a strong, readable silhouette amidst chaos
- Enemies — distinct silhouettes that communicate combat role and can be told apart
- Elements — immediately readable fire, electricity, and ice effects

Player & Interface Design

The vertical slice requires an original player character, a clear combat silhouette, and UI that communicates health, resources, upgrades, rewards, shops, and elemental effects without breaking the dark-fantasy presentation.

Environmental Identity

The first zone establishes the production baseline for Reditus Umbrae: shadowy arena spaces with enough variation to support combat rooms, reward and special rooms, the shop, landmarks, transitions, a mini-boss arena, and a distinct final boss space.

Enemy & Entity Design

The five enemy archetypes, mini-boss, and zone boss should communicate their combat roles. Silhouette, scale, weapon or attack language, animation, and VFX reinforce threat and readability.

THANK YOU.

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GET IN TOUCH WITH US

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